

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to ask for a favor!



Learning Outcome

Explains customs and appropriate behavior at work and in different countries, using a wider range of expressions and formulas.

Can Do Statements

- I can ask for and respond to favors.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk about my attitudes toward an action.

Ask your partner:

- When have you asked a friend or family member to do you a favor?
- When someone does you a favor, how to you repay them?

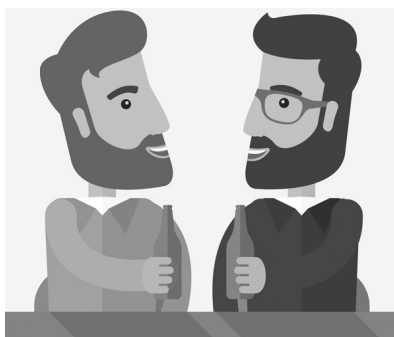




Let's Explore!

Ferdinand needs Paulo to **get to the bottom of it***.

* To "get to the bottom of something" means to solve a mystery.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Ferdinand:** Paulo! Great to see you! How are things?
Paulo: Good. Hey ... would you do me a favor?
Ferdinand: It would be my pleasure.
Paulo: Would you mind getting us a drink? I enjoy drinking and chatting.
Ferdinand: No worries. You deserve to drink something cold in this hot weather. Could I get us beers?
Paulo: Sure. So, I didn't expect to see you in Brazil so soon. Did you happen to come here for business or pleasure?
Ferdinand: When I travel abroad, I manage to mix business with pleasure. This time I regret to inform you that it is urgent business. Could I ask you to help me with something? What's your schedule like these days?
Paulo: Busy! But you know me! Never able to mind my own business ... I'd be happy to help you.
Ferdinand: I need someone to investigate the business practices of a clothing company - Holly's. Can you do that for me?
Paulo: Absolutely.
Ferdinand: Would you consider doing me a huge favor? I need you to look up Farmani. He's the owner and appears to be closely connected to this.
Paulo: What's your connection?
Ferdinand: Polygon - the company I work for - was hired to promote their business. The rumor is that Farmani's agreed to outsource his labor and it relies on employing child labor.
Paulo: Wow. What are the details?
Ferdinand: Only a rumor. I'm asking you to get to the truth. Would it be too much trouble for you to get some background on Farmani's business practices in other areas?
Paulo: For sure. I'll work on getting to the bottom of this.





Let's Practice!

Ferdinand asks Paulo for a few favors. What are they? How does Paulo respond?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Underline all the phrases that ask for a favor or respond to a request. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Ferdinand: Excuse me, Ferdinand. Could I bother you to help me with something?

Paulo: I'd be happy to help you!

Ferdinand: I need someone to investigate the business practices of a clothing company. Can you do that for me?

Paulo: Absolutely.

Ferdinand: I'm just asking you to get to the truth. Would it be too much trouble for you to get some background on Farmani's business practices in other areas?

Paulo: It would be my pleasure.



Let's Practice!

It's important to choose the correct verb!

Instructions: Place the words into the correct category.

1. You could expect ...
2. Did you enjoy ...
3. You ask ...
4. You can rely on ...
5. I can manage ...
6. You should work on ...
7. Will you consider ...

8. Would you mind ...
9. You deserve ...
10. You agree ...
11. You should appear ...
12. I happen ...
13. We need ...

Verbs followed by an infinitive

Verbs followed by a gerund



Extension Activity

Ask your partner for a favor.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write down 5 things that you need or need done.
- Think of a polite way to ask your partner to do these things for you.
- Take turns with your partner asking for a favor and letting your partner ask you for a favor.
- Respond to your partner's request by agreeing or politely refusing to help.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I ask for and respond to favors.

☐ ☐

I list things that I need.

☐ ☐

I ask my partner for a favor.

☐ ☐

I agree or refuse to help my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **business or pleasure** (expression): for work or enjoyment, personal happiness
e.g. Did you happen to come here for business or pleasure?
- **mix business with pleasure** (expression): combine work and fun
e.g. When I travel abroad, I manage to mix business with pleasure.
- **urgent** (adjective): very important
e.g. I regret to inform you that it is urgent business.
- **to mind your own business** (expression): to not ask someone private questions
e.g. I'm never able to mind my own business.
- **to investigate** (verb): to look for information on a subject
e.g. I need someone to investigate the business practices of a clothing company.
- **business practices** (noun): a set of working methods
e.g. I feel like their business practices are not ethical.
- **labor** (noun): work
e.g. Farmani has agreed to outsource his labor.
- **to be closely connected to** (expression): to have a close relationship
e.g. He's the owner and appears to be closely connected to this.





Learning Points

Making and Responding to Polite Requests

You use the modals *can*, *could* and *would* to politely ask someone to do something for you.

The structure is:

Can/Could/Would + you + verb

For example:

Could you get me a drink?

You can also use phrases like:

Could you do me a favor?

Can I ask you for a favor?

Could you do something for me?

To respond to a polite request you can say:

It would be my pleasure.

Of course.

Absolutely.

I'd be happy help you.

I'm sorry. I can't.

I would love to, but ...

Modal Verb		Polite request
can	polite	<i>Can you do that for me?</i>
could	more polite	<i>Could you do me a huge favor?</i>
would	most polite	<i>Would you please get me a drink?</i>

Examples:

- *Would you do me a favor?*
- *Could I ask you to help me with something?*
- *Can you do that for me?*
- *Could you also do me a huge favor?*
- *It would be my pleasure.*





Learning Points

Gerunds and Infinitives

A **gerund** is a verb ending with -ing (doing).

An **infinitive** is to + verb (to do).

There are rules about which verbs you can use with gerunds and which verbs you can use with infinitives.

Verbs commonly followed by a gerund include verbs that express **likes/dislikes**:

- like
- love
- enjoy
- dislike
- hate
- mind

Example:

*Would you **mind getting** us a drink?*

- *like/love/hate* can also be followed by an Infinitive

Some other verbs that are followed by a gerund:

- anticipate
- consider
- delay
- complete
- involve
- suggest
- risk
- regret

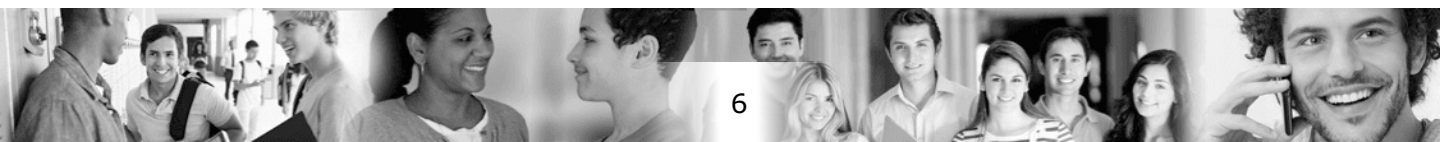
You use gerunds after prepositions:

*Farmani's company **relies on employing** child labor.*

*He was **accused of telling** lies about his business.*

These are some verbs that are followed by an infinitive:

- hope
- seem
- need
- manage
- appear
- deserve





Learning Points

- expect
- ask
- happen

Example:

*I **manage to mix** business with pleasure*

You use infinitives after adjectives.

Example:

*I'd be **happy to help** you. I was never **able to mind** my own business.*

Examples:

- *I enjoy drinking and chatting.*
- *You deserve to drink something cold in this hot weather.*
- *I didn't expect to see you in Brazil so soon.*
- *I'll work on getting the truth.*
- *The rumour is that Farmani's agreed to outsource his labor.*

